

about YOUR INVESTIGATOR

A WEARY VICTOR, YOU'VE stymied another threat from the Cthulhu Mythos, but at great sacrifice. You need rest. You go to Arkham, a peaceful college town, to recover. Little do you dream the fate awaiting you....

An investigator is a game persona whom you control. Investigators seek out gates and monsters of the Cthulhu Mythos in order to drive them from Arkham.

Each investigator card contains the same information. The skill values vary, since the cards represent different people.

Select an investigator card, then put red markers on the sanity points and strength points columns. Adjust the markers up or down as indicated in the course of play.

Small plastic markers match investigator card colors: black, blue, green, orange, purple, red, silver, and yellow.

- A new investigator's strength points plus sanity points equal 10. An investigator in top shape has 7 sanity and 7 strength points; yours is recovering from previous bouts with the Mythos. Divide the points as you wish, so long as each column has at least 3 points. Once the game starts, points may not be interchanged.

- When starting a new investigator during the game, begin play in the next turn, in your regular player order.

Strength Points

An investigator's strength points measure the physical health of the investigator and reflect the physical effects of battle with Mythos monsters. Strength points earned in excess of 7 are lost.

Strength points do not measure fighting prowess for investigators: use the Fight skill as a measure. Strength points do measure the prowess of monsters.

All strength rolls are D6 rolls against an investigator's present strength, not his or her maximum possible strength. A result higher than the current strength means the roll fails.

If strength points are low, move the investigator to the Hospital and follow the location instructions. Other ways of raising strength points also exist.

An investigator who runs out of strength points in Arkham is moved immediately to the Hospital, losing one item as penalty if any are held.

An investigator who runs out of strength points in an Other World is lost: replace all cards in the proper stacks and shuffle. Start a new investigator.

OPTION: Strength points can reflect the number of items your investigator picks up, one item for each point. Though items are not discarded to account for dips in strength, an investigator cannot pick up anything unless

his or her strength points exceed the number of items presently carried — or unless the investigator drops something to make room.

Sanity

Sanity measures the investigator's mental stability and reflect the mental effects of confronting the horrors of the Cthulhu Mythos. Sanity points earned in excess of 7 are lost.

All sanity rolls are D6. If the result equals or is less than the investigator's current sanity, then the sight of the monster costs the amount of sanity points written before the slash on the monster piece. If the roll is greater than the investigator's current sanity, then the investigator loses the number of sanity points written after the slash.

If more than one species of monster is met in a space or location, make a sanity roll for each as combated. If Sneaking from a monster-occupied space or location, roll immediately only for the monster with greatest potential impact against sanity. If carried via nightgaunt through a monster-infested location, do not make a sanity roll.

An investigator cannot exhaust sanity in order to cast a spell.

When sanity points are low, move the investigator to the Sanitarium and follow the location instructions. Other ways of raising sanity points also exist.

If an investigator's sanity value reaches zero, that investigator is temporarily insane. Place the marker in the Sanitarium. As penalty, the investigator loses 1 spell card of choice if any are held.

If an investigator goes insane in Other Worlds, he or she is lost. If lost, replace all cards and monsters in the proper places and shuffle, then start a new investigator.

- An investigator heinously attacking another investigator or destroying a gate and thereby stranding an investigator then suffers a D6 sanity point loss from remorse.

Skills

Each investigator has four skills.

At times each player must attempt D6 skill rolls for his or her investigator. If the total of the roll is equal to or less than the investigator's skill value, then he or she succeeds using the skill. If the result of the roll is greater than the skill value, then that skill use failed.

A skill card augments one investigator skill. Identical cards augment: two Fight +1, for instance, add 2 points to a Fight skill.

Spells

Arkham is awash with books and manuscripts about Mythos monsters. Each

edition of a book contains one usable spell, represented by a spell card. Each card bears the name of a book, the spell it contains, any sanity point cost, and the spell's attack strength or other function. See the game terms section for additional information about particular spells.

An investigator can use only the spell cards he or she holds. The number held has no limit. A particular spell card can be used once per game turn.

Only investigators use spells. Spells work against all monsters. Spells are effective only within the caster's space. A spell can benefit another investigator.

- To cast a spell, the player must make a successful Knowledge roll. Failing, the spell cannot be cast that turn. Put failed and cast spells face down. At the next turn's start, place all spell cards face up.

A spell can be cast at any time, but any sanity cost must be paid before a spell takes effect. No sanity is lost if a Knowledge roll fails, since the spell was not cast.

Items

Each item is represented by one item card. Items are either magical or ordinary. Magical items are marked, and (if weapons) count as magical attacks even though tangible. No Knowledge roll is needed. Items not marked magical make physical attacks.

Some items note 1H or 2H: no more than two 1H or one 2H item can be used in any one attack; 1H stands for one hand, 2H stands for two hands. An item may need no hands to use.

An item is effective only within a space.

After surviving a location event, any item worth more than \$1 may be sold at half list price (round up any fraction) to Hib's Roadhouse or to the Curiosity Shoppe; a \$1 item may not be sold there. Draw the money from the bank; discard the item.

If an auction card is drawn in place of a physical item, that card nonetheless counts as the player's gained item. For auctions, see the Card Explanations.

Charity Cards

Desiring charity, an investigator goes to the Benevolent Order of Dagon Mission and follows location instructions. The investigator must have a charity card. Further, the investigator either must have (1) no spells, or no money, or no items, or (2) have the fewest spells, or money, or items of all the investigators.

The Order grants charity in one category of the player's choice (which also satisfies the requirements above).

In repayment, the investigator must dispatch a monster or close a gate before the charity card can be used again, and the Benevolent Order of Dagon collects all such trophies in any location or Other World: those trophies return to the monster pile and gate deck, respectively.

A charity card is usable any number of times. Money, items, or spells may not be discarded in order to gain charity. A player need never use charity.

To remind the player that a Dagon repayment is due, flip the charity card to the side reading "Repay Charity With Good Works," then flip the card back to the side bearing the large "Charity" when payment is made.

Making Trades

Money, charity cards, item cards, spell cards, and local character cards may be traded at any time, so long as the traders occupy the same space. Skill cards may be traded before the game begins.

Starting A New Investigator

An investigator may be selected or drawn randomly.

The new investigator begins at the Train Station, with a complement of 1 skill card, 1 spell card, 1 charity card, 3 item cards, and \$13 from the bank. Allot a total of 10 points between the investigator's sanity and strength points, with a minimum of 3 in either.

The player maintains his or her place in the game. The new investigator begins action in the game turn following the demise of the previous investigator.

If you wish, new players may enter the game at the start of any turn. Remember that the victory conditions may change if the total number of investigators changes.

The Roll Of Honor

Use the Roll of Honor to record the investigator who destroyed the most gates. If a tie exists for the most gates destroyed, award the position on the Roll of Honor to the investigator who has collected the highest number of monster points. If a tie still exists, record the tying investigators.

Also record the player, the number of gates eliminated, and the number of strength points of the investigator's trophy monsters.

Some players like to use the accumulated strength points of the gates to determine whose investigator is honored as First Citizen. If you prefer this, agree to it before play begins.

Questions And Answers

Q: How can we win?

A: You're likely to lose the first game or two. No matter how skillful you become, you'll always stand a chance of losing. Balance your desire to be entered on the Roll of Honor with the usefulness of cooperation: players who actively confer and concentrate on helping each other win most often. Trade skills before play begins. Take advantage of

opportunities to trade during the game. Plan for your investigators to occasionally meet. Help another investigator close a gate by loaning or giving the item or spell most useful. Winners successfully balance personal advantage with the goal of the game.

Q: What do we do first?

A: During the early turns, explore downtown Arkham to add additional items and spells. Monsters tend to appear first on the outer fringes of town.

Q: How should we answer rules questions?

A: Play this game like a horror movie: be courageous and adventurous. In that spirit, make informal agreements about rules meanings. Study the order of play closely. If no other agreement can be reached, the owner of the game has final say.

Q: How can I move with all these monsters around?

A: The simplest way to is to lower the population — go out and beat up on some monsters! Failing that, try moving from location to location. Though powers and ghosts can appear and remain in locations, only a Hound of Tindalos can enter a location (and then only buildings). Coordinated movement between investigators can draw flying monsters away from investigators who must expose themselves. Don't forget taxis and taxi whistle cards: they're there to help.

Q: Where do we find things?

A: To gain money, spells, and items, or to increase sanity and strength, study the location tables in the Arkham Gazette, especially the Curiosity Shoppe, Dagon Mission, Hospital, Library, and Sanitarium.

Q: What's the best way to destroy gates?

A: If you must close gates during the early game, close those with lesser chances of re-opening. Closing gates too quickly may accelerate the doom factor. Strengthen the investigators, then act decisively. If possible, have all the investigators jump through gates in the same turn. To win, you'll need to close an average of two gates per turn. Use Elder Signs on locations like Founder's Rock and the Silver Twilight Lodge.

Q: How come investigators sometimes escape from monsters?

A: In earlier days, short-story heroes and heroines fainted in the presence of horror, thereby escaping the foul attentions of monsters and evil-doers. *Arkham Horror*, set some three generations ago, naturally follows suit. Late twentieth-century monsters are much more bloodthirsty — players take note.

Q: What happens if I take a ride to another location?

A: Because of location events, an investigator may travel to several locations in one turn. When an investigator enters a location or remains in a location, roll on that location table unless a monster is met or a gate transit is made.

Q: When should I use spells?

A: Use spells and items at any time, but always roll for the location or gate event

immediately upon entering, and always make sanity rolls before attacking monsters.

Q: How do I use Bind Monster spells?

A: The best way to use a bound monster is to destroy a gate. The released monster is sucked through the gate along with any guardians, and the gate and all the monsters add to your trophy stack. If you use the spell to attack another monster, the bound monster is released after battle and again travels the streets of Arkham. Set the monster in any adjacent space and point it in the direction you wish.

Q: What do I do about powers?

A: Don't fight a power directly: you'll usually lose. Instead, brave the sanity loss and try to destroy the gate which the power guards. Destroying the gate sucks the power through, and you add it and the gate to your trophy stack just like any other monster.

Q: If a location has a gate, can a second gate appear on it?

A: Only one gate per location, ever. If a location event calls for a second gate, ignore that part of the instruction, but do put the accompanying monster on the location.

Q: How did we do?

A: Counting the strength points in your trophy piles is a convenient way to compare efforts. The test, though, is how satisfied you feel: if you all worked hard toward the mutual goal, you'll feel good about the result, regardless of whose name goes on the Roll of Honor.

Terms, Procedures, Card Explanations



Auction: drawer calls an auction, then draws the next two item cards in the deck, discarding back into the deck any additional auction cards. Request bids for one item at a time, always starting at \$1. The auctioneer may bid as well, but is not required to bid.

If the item is sold, the auctioneer gets half of the selling price and the other half (including any odd dollar) goes to the bank. If an item is not sold, the auctioneer may pay list price for it. If the auctioneer buys the item at bid, the auctioneer pays full price.

Bidders may be in any space, location, or Other World.

An item may be bid toward the ownership of another item, at the cash value of the item. To make change, put the item back in the deck and draw the change from the bank. The auctioneer always receives cash value, not an item, in such a transaction.

Attacks You in Buildings Only: the Hound of Tindalos attacks only in buildings. The Hound cannot attack in the following locations and Other Worlds where right angles are apt not to be found: Black Cave, Devil's Beach, Founder's Rock, Graveyard, Lake Miskatonic, Woods, the Abyss, Earth's Dreamlands (despite the illustration), or the Plateau of Leng, and goes back into the

monster pile without effect. Do not draw a replacement monster. Once a Hound has inflicted damage, put it back in the monster pile.

Back Doors: Three locations, the Dagon Mission, the Boarding House, and Miskatonic University, have two entrances. All entrances to locations are marked; none are unmarked.

Bind Monster: to use this spell, the target monster must be on the gameboard. The investigator must be in or move to a space in which the target rests. Once there, and with a successful Knowledge roll, the investigator may (1) choose to banish the monster to the investigator's trophy pile; (2) choose to have the monster move with the investigator and to make an attack against a monster or a gate at some time in this or a later turn.

The investigator adds his Fight, spells, items, etc., to the bound monster's attack, as desired.

Exception: the five powers are immune to Bind Monster.

A Bound monster moving with an investigator resembles an item except that it does not count against strength. The thing moves at the same rate and in the same space as the investigator. Ignore attacking other investigators, handedness, etc. Imagine the monster as potential, not as occupying space.

Treat the attack of a Bound monster as a weapon. It is always a physical attack unless set against a monster of the same species — ghost against ghost, for instance.

In a successful attack against a gate, the Bound monster is added to your trophy pile as well as the gate.

In a successful attack against a monster, the target monster is added to your trophy pile, and the Bound monster is set free in any adjacent space of your choice.

A Bind Monster spell card can be successfully cast once. Then the card must be returned to the spells deck.

Blockers: monsters big enough to halt vehicular movement one space distant. 'One space distant' does not mean adjacent: there must be an intervening space between the blocker and the halted traveler.

Byakhee: The phrase < flyer > is missing from the front of the byakhee counters: they are nonetheless flyer monsters.

Cloud Memory: adds 2 sanity points to you or to the investigator of your choice in the same space or location.

Dice: two six-sided dice, abbreviated D6 for one and 2D6 for two, are included with this game.

Discard: also, place card in deck, replace card in deck, return card to deck, etc. Put the card face up at the bottom of the pile. When a face-up card appears, reshuffle the cards.

Doom Factor: the counter measuring the strain upon the local continuum. When the counter moves beyond 13, no way exists to reverse the doom track, and the game is lost.

Dread Curse of Azathoth: adds a magical attack of +9 against a target, and costs 2 sanity points each time it is successfully cast.

Drops You Through Nearest Gate: If the nightgaunt makes a successful attack, it

does no harm to strength points (check for sanity, of course) but carries the investigator through the nearest gate. Put the investigator in Box 2 of the appropriate Other World, and leave the nightgaunt in the space which the investigator formerly occupied. If grabbed on an Other World, the nightgaunt takes you to Arkham, through the gate by which you originally left Arkham.

Elder Sign: an Elder Sign destroys a gate. To use one, go through any gate, then return to Arkham. Spend 2 sanity points. Add the gate card to your trophy stack. Leave the Elder Sign card on the location. Move the doom factor marker back one (from 11 to 10, etc.). Once played, an Elder Sign may not be moved. An Elder Sign remains on a location after a gate is destroyed, preventing further gates and/or monsters from appearing there. The Elder Sign does not stop the Hound of Tindalos from entering a building.

Fast Talk: a skill causing immediate agreement. Of no use against Mythos monsters. A successful Fast Talk during a purchase buys an item or translation for \$1 less than listed price. *Option: failing a Fast Talk roll when bargaining about money raises the cost of the item or service by \$1.*

Fight: a skill, an investigator's built-in physical attack, including punching, biting, kicking, etc. Add the investigator's Fight skill to all physical attacks, but never to an attack against a monster immune to physical attack. *Option: two investigators in the same space who both attack monsters each receive a +1 Fight bonus.*

Find Gate: this spell is effective only on an Other World. Use it to return to Arkham after you arrive in the Other World. It can be used before movement, or before combat with a monster after surviving the sanity roll.

Flesh Ward: automatically cancels any one monster attack or counterattack in a turn.

Flyers: monsters bearing the letter F before their movement rate (F-9, etc.) are flyers. Flyers have no handedness; they move toward the nearest investigator located on the sidewalk. Except for the Hound of Tindalos, flyers do not enter locations after appearing on the board.

The phrase < flyer > is missing from the front of the byakhee counters: they are nonetheless flyer monsters.

Gates: a gate is a magical doorway between Arkham and an Other World. The 8 areas at the top of the map are Other Worlds, to which the gate cards lead.

Ghosts: like powers, ghosts do not move, and any number can stay in a location. To Sneak past ghosts and powers, either to visit an Other World or to close a gate, roll for sanity against each guardian in the location. To attack one of the guardians, make a sanity roll only for the entity to be attacked.

Guardians: normally, either a power or a ghost: see those entries.

Handed: monster counters bearing circles or diamonds move right or left according to the position of the sign and the R or L notation with the movement rate. Further, some investigator items require one or two hands to use: see the Items section, above.

Harmed By Magic And Silver Bullet:

the werewolf is harmed by magical items, by spells, and by the silver bullet fireable by any gun.

Heal: successful cast adds 2 strength points to the specified investigator in the same space as the caster.

Killed, Put in Monster Pile; Take 1 Item: the migo counter returns to the monster pile to be drawn again. No trophies are earned for these monsters, but draw 1 card from the Items deck in return.

Knowledge: a skill, the ability to learn, remember, and analyze; an individual D6 Knowledge roll must be successfully completed each time a spell is cast.

Local Characters: the two cards each add a +2 to an investigator's Fight. Additionally, each can substitute for an investigator by taking one attack or counterattack from a monster in Arkham or an Other World, but then must be discarded. Local characters are not items, nor do they carry or use items.

Magical Attacks: spells, magical items, and an attack by a monster on another of its own species constitute magical attacks.

Mists of R'lyeh: allows you one automatically successful Sneak per turn.

Monsters: 49 1-inch-square pieces.

Only Magic Harms It: only a spell or a magical item can be used to attack this thing: ordinary items and the Fight skill are useless and have no effect, though the D6 roll still applies. Exception: the same species of Mythos creature, if Bound and directed to attack its brother, counts as a magical attack.

Origination Classes: all the monsters are color-coded to one of nine schemes. Eight schemes match the colors of the eight Other Worlds: putatively, the monsters of a certain color come from the matching Other World. When a gate is destroyed, check the monsters on the board and remove any matching that Other World. Put them in the monster pile, not in your trophy pile. The ninth scheme is black and white, representing monsters unaffected by destruction of gates.

Other Worlds: the 8 areas at the top of the map represent 8 Other Worlds to which investigators may go.

Physical Attack: the Fight skill, ordinary weapons, the D6 roll, and Mythos monster attacks constitute physical attacks.

Powder of Ibn-Ghazi: adds a magical attack of +7 against a target, but costs 1 sanity point each time successfully cast.

Power Drain: adds a magical attack of +6 against a target, but costs 1 sanity point each time successfully cast.

Powers: the strongest and hugest monsters, these entities do not move (but after a game is lost, presumably, they wobble and gibber down the streets of Arkham). A power is unaffected by the Bind Monster spell. Two or more powers and ghosts can stack on a location: to Sneak by them to enter an Other World or to close a gate, a sanity roll must be made for each guardian. To attack one of the guardians, make a sanity roll only for the entity to be attacked.

Retainers: \$2 per turn retainers can be found at Miskatonic U. and the Newspaper. Only four retainer cards exist: no more than

four retainer payments are made per turn.

Shrivelling: adds a magical attack of +6 against a target, but costs 1 sanity point each time successfully cast.

Sneak: how well an investigator can evade monsters. If successful, put investigator in any adjacent space or location and then roll for sanity loss. If more than one monster in the space, any needed sanity roll concerns only the most ghastly of the monsters. Sneak can be used to get past a gate guardian to enter an Other World. If unsuccessful, the sneaker must confront the monster. Sanity is still rolled before an attack or counterattack can occur. Exception: Sneak may not be used if all adjacent spaces and locations contain monsters. Exception: Sneak cannot be used against a Hound of Tindalos in a building.

Spaces: locations are linked by streets. Streets are divided into spaces quantifying movement. For convenience, locations and Other World boxes often are also termed spaces.

Taxis: taxis are printed on several gameboard spaces. Stopping on one offers quick investigator movement in return for \$1. Location events also provide taxi or other vehicle service.

Tindalos: though all monsters enter Arkham through gated locations, the Hound is the only monster which can enter a location from the street. The location must be a building: Black Cave, Devil's Beach, Founder's Rock, Graveyard, Lake Miskatonic, and Woods are not buildings. In Other Worlds, treat the Hound as no encounter in The Abyss, Earth's Dreamlands, and the Plateau of Leng for various reasons. In other than buildings, the Tindalos moves through investigators and vice versa without stopping or other effect.

Alone of the monsters, a Tindalos is put back into the monster pile after any attack which inflicts a strength point loss on an investigator. Once back in the monster pile, a Tindalos can be drawn again normally.

An investigator cannot Sneak against a Tindalos.

Trophy Stacks: keep the monsters and gates which an investigator eliminates. The investigator with the most gates (or the most gates and monsters, as a tie-breaker) at the end of the game has his or her name inscribed on the Roll of Honor.

Unharmful By Guns: attacks made by shotguns, rifles, pistols, and revolvers have no effect on such creatures. All other attacks are carried out normally.

Vampire: each successive Random Monster Appearance step increases the vampire's strength points by 1: add a penny or other acceptable token to the vampire, representing the additional strength point. For convenience, stack the pennies somewhere in the Graveyard. A vampire harnessed by a Bind Monster spell attacks at its present strength, not its original strength.

Weapons Do 1 Point Damage: each physical attack does minimum damage to this thing — there just wasn't enough room on the counter to comfortably write it properly. Example: an investigator uses his Fight skill, his revolver, and a sword against a shoggoth. Each is a physical weapon, and each

therefore does the minimum damage, 1 point. The total attack, 3 points, is too little to affect the thing, even with a D6 add.

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GATE APPEARANCE TABLE

2D6 location

- 2 — Shunned House
- 3 — Dark's Carnival
- 4 — Lighthouse
- 5 — Devil's Beach
- 6 — Graveyard
- 7 — Founder's Rock; Additionally, 1 Monster Appears On Each Presently Gated Location.
- 8 — Silver Twilight Lodge
- 9 — Wood
- 10 — Lake Miskatonic
- 11 — Harney Jones' Shack
- 12 — Black Cave

ORDER OF PLAY

Investigator Phase

Collect Money if on Retainer;
Return to Arkham if Starting on Other Worlds Box 1; and

1. Investigator Acts:
 - Waits, or
 - Moves, or
 - Moves and Takes Taxi.
2. Investigator Encounters:
 - Waits, or
 - Rolls for Encounter,
 - Adds Sanity Points,
 - Adds Strength Points,
 - Earns/Loses Money,
 - Purchases/Finds Item,
 - Uses a Skill,
 - Uses a Charity Card,
 - Meets a Monster.
3. Investigator Meets a Monster:
 - Has a Sanity Roll, (maybe)
 - Goes Temporarily Insane, or
 - Waits,
 - Sneaks, or
 - Fights.
4. Investigator Fights:
 - Attacks and
 - Risks Counterattack.

Mythos Phase

1. Random Gate Appears:
 - Roll On Gate Appearance Table.
2. All Monsters Move.
3. All Monsters Attack:
 - Make Applicable Investigator Sanity Rolls,
 - Monster Attacks,
 - Investigator Sneaks, or
 - Investigator Counterattacks.

